Mobile Tool Library: Grant Proposal

Submitted to: City Neighborhood Grant Committee **Applicant:** Eastside Neighbors Association **Contact:** Rosa Delgado, Program Lead **Amount requested:** $18,500 **Deadline:** December 1, 2026

Summary

Eastside Neighbors Association asks the committee for $18,500 to start a Mobile Tool Library: a used cargo van stocked with basic tools that visits three neighborhoods each week and lends tools for free. We plan to launch on Saturday, April 3, 2027. In the first year, to April 2028, we aim to make 400 tool loans to 150 different households.

The need

In September 2026 we surveyed 212 households. Of those, 38% said they lack the basic tools for home repairs. Residents told us that buying a tool for a single repair is not worth the cost, so repairs get put off.

A drill, a ladder or a saw is needed rarely but is expensive to own. Lending these tools makes small repairs possible without a purchase.

The project

We will buy a used cargo van and fit it with shelving and racks, then stock it with starter tools: drills, ladders, saws and garden tools. The van will visit three neighborhoods every week, on Tuesday evenings and Saturday mornings.

Borrowing is free. Each borrower signs a one-page waiver and the tool is logged out on a sign-out sheet. Loans last 7 days. Expensive items also carry a small deposit.

Timeline

When	Milestone
January to February 2027	Buy the used cargo van and shelving
February to March 2027	Stock the starter tool inventory
March 2027	Train 20 volunteers
Saturday, April 3, 2027	Launch
September 2027	Train 10 more volunteers
April 2028	First-year goals measured

Goals for the first year

- 400 tool loans
- 150 different households served

We will report to the committee quarterly.

Budget

Item	Cost (USD)
Used cargo van	9,800
Shelving and racks	1,950
Starter tool inventory	4,200
Insurance (first year)	1,150
Waivers and printing	400
Volunteer training	1,000
Total request	**18,500**

The grant covers the whole startup cost listed above. Van maintenance is not in this request. We will pay for it from a maintenance fund built from donations.

Risks and how we will handle them

- **Van breakdown.** Repairs will be paid from the donation-funded maintenance fund, not from this grant.
- **Tools not returned.** Every loan has a signed waiver and a sign-out log, and expensive items require a small deposit.
- **Volunteer turnover.** We will train 20 volunteers before launch and train 10 more in September 2027.

Contact

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